



Carrigtwohill & District Historical Society

Christmas Newsletter 2025

Committee Business

Chairman's Address

By Jim Barry

Another year has passed and Christmas is with us again. This year indeed will be remembered as a very eventful one.

The main project at hand at the beginning of the year was the publication of the Parish history book, which turned out to be a more complicated task than originally thought. The aim was to have the book launched in early November to avail of the Christmas market. It was generally accepted that the book would cover Parish History, going back about 300 years with a summary of the origins of Carrigtwohill and its famous family's. Several contributors submitted articles for inclusion on this theme.

The book was printed by CarrigPrint and launched on the 24th October at the Carrigtwohill GAA Clubhouse by Denis Walsh. Our thanks to Denis Walsh, Caroline Dixey, the GAA club, and to all who made the night such a great success. Our thanks are also due to Mary Finn and the Vincent de Paul shop on the Main St for their help in selling the book. Feedback is very positive and it will be nearly sold out by the year end.

Towards the end of last year, the Society made applications to the Community Monuments Fund for funding to help with conservation of the Abbey Tower at St Davids Old Graveyard which I am delighted to say was successful. Some preservation work has been carried out during the year which will help in preserving the Tower for future generations. That said, the whole area St David's Church; the Tower and Graveyard are now up for sale by the Church of Ireland. Our Society will have to pay close attention to any transaction in this regard. I am amazed few have commented so far, but who knows most people are happy with a small piece of a graveyard like 8ft x 4ft, but maybe that's a dying trade, perhaps they might find room to build an apartment block there.

As the Society was an unincorporated body entering into a large conservation project, it was decided to form a company limited by guarantee (CLG). This task was executed by Society member, Michael White and his son Robert. There are three directors; Michael Cummins, Ollie Sheehan, and Michael White as Secretary.

In early October we had a visit from a large group of Cotters from Wisconsin in the US, they would be direct descendants of James Cotter (Jemmy) who was executed in Broad Lane in Cork in May 1720. The visit was coordinated by Mary and Pat Cotter from Marquette County WI. who along with the group stayed at the Commodore Hotel in Cobh arriving on Saturday 4th, arrangements were made to meet them on Sunday. Representing the historical society, Marie Fitzgerald McCarthy, Michael Cummins, and I met them at the Commodore on Sunday. We travelled to Belvelly (they had

three hired cars) spending about 20 minutes we went through the Castle history and its connection with the Cotters, and took some photos. Then off to Ann Grove where we met Michael White who gave a talk on Ann Grove House, and the Cotters. From there we traveled to St Davids Carrigtwohill and a talk on the Cotter Monument and what happened to it, then off to Lisgoold. One of them has a connection to Lisgoold through marriage.

They invited my wife and myself to a meal in the Commodore on Sunday night which was very enjoyable. On Monday Michael Cummins and myself, presented them with a stone from the old house at Ann Grove mounted on a wooden plaque with all their names engraved on a brass plate. They presented Michael with a donation for the society.

Mary assured me they very much appreciated the reception they received, so we all shook hands and wished them a safe journey home.

Here's to another one. ---- Happy Christmas to All

Phone 087 2533768, or email jimei8gs@gmail.com

Society Business

By André Saubolle (Secretary)

Christmas is with us and another year has also so quickly passed us by.

It is regrettable, however, we have been unable to get out our regular circulars for a variety of reasons. This does not mean that our committee and membership, with the assistance from members of the local community been kept very busy throughout the year. These include The Tidy Towns, Carrigtwohill Community Council, the C2H040 Steering Committee, just to name a few.

It was also not possible to put on our usual monthly presentations, or lectures by guest speakers.

Jim has provided a general overview of the year, which is now further outlined chronologically as best possible, putting more context to Jim's message:

- Based on legal advice in relation to the book publication and the Abbey Project it was decided the society would become a company limited by guarantee (CLG). It was further decided that no AGM would be held until this was formally accomplished.
- In lead up to the 21st/22nd July weekend of the 150th anniversary commemorations of Poor Servants of the Mother of God's arrival in the village, several members of the committee were also members of the steering committee of this event. On display was a draft of the Tourist Information Panel; a revised of which is now to be placed at the Grotto

to accompany the planting of the eleven trees in honour of the native Sisters of Carrigtwohill who entered the Order. This is to be undertaken by Carrigtwohill's Tidy Towns.

- On the 5th October 2019, at the height of the Covid pandemic, Ollie Sheehan was in correspondence with Mary Cottor of Ohio who was preparing for a visit to Carrigtwohill the following year. Being personally busy Ollie forwarded Mary's enquiry to me to liaise with her and to organise their visit. This was done during a telephone conversation with Mary who was in the field tending her cattle. Weeks later it was with much regret I had to inform her that the Government had imposed restrictions on the movement of the population. This she was unaware of, but agreed to make arrangements with her party once the crisis was over
- The successful publication of the book of the parish history was launched at the GAA clubhouse, 24th October. It was the culmination of eighteen months of collating contributors' article of various topics and formatting before being presented to CarrigPrint to produce. This was financed by Eirgrid Community Fund awarded us in January 2024.

It is sadly noted the death of Brian Birmingham and Richard Cooke who were founding members of the Cork Celebrates Cork Past Exhibition which was subsequently canceled, and it is hoped will only be a temporary postponement.

We now summarise the events the year.

Membership Renewal

Join or Renew
your Membership



We are all so very much aware that this is a difficult financial time of year for many, so hope you will forgive our reminder that membership renewal will fall due from the 1st January 2026. This you may do in person to any committee member, or via PayPal by clicking the link [Log in to your PayPal account](#).

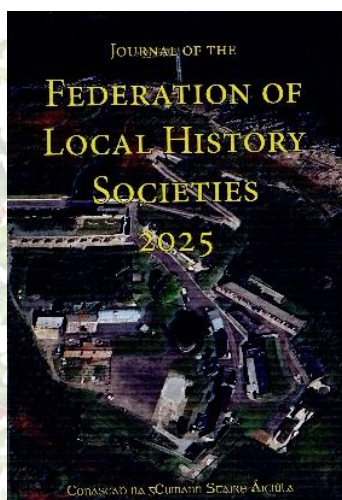
Our membership subscription remains unchanged as €20.

We are a voluntary committee who would be delighted to welcome anyone willing to spare their time to promote the rich cultural heritage that is Carrigtwohill. We meet generally the last Thursday of the month. If you feel you are able, please do come and join us.

We also have members of the Carrigtwohill Diaspora who are members with a few who have an interest in our village's diverse history.



Federation of Local History Societies Annual



This year there was only one member's contribution to the journal by Marie J FitzGerald McCarthy. It was the story entitled Wearing the Habit of the Poor Servants of the Mother of God, Sisters.

As usual, the journal is festooned with many interesting subjects. After the usual introductions and forewords, it opens with an article about

Frank Taaffe. He was not directly involved in the "Remembering Edward Bransfield" project, but was an avid supporter who I corresponded with for a time, and who we met the day we visited the Shackleton Museum in Athy before the unveiling of Edward's memorial in Ballinacurra attended by many of our members.

Another was written by Geraldine Healy reminiscing upon her youth during the 1950s/60s, and in particular her visits to Roche's Store.

Throughout, are photographs of our friends at Passage West who partially hosted events at this year's Federation AGM.

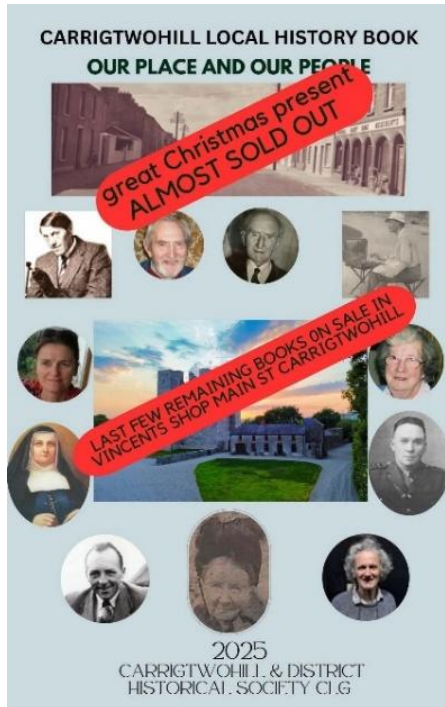
There then followed an extremely interesting article about the Fr O'Neill of Ballymacoda and the rebellion of 1798 by Philip O'Neill.

For your copy contact the editor, Larry Breen on their website contact page: [Contact Us – Federation of Local History Societies – Cónascadh na gCumann Staire Áitiúla](#)

Book of the Parish History

The Book Launch

By Michael Cummins



On 24th October, we celebrated the launch of the 1st Local History Book from the Carrigtwohill & District Historical Society, entitled "Our Place and Our People." In typical Irish

fashion, the room upstairs in the GAA Clubhouse went from a worrying 20% full to 150% full in the final 10 minutes before 7.30 start time. In the end, it was standing room only for those at the back. We had a very warm, welcoming speech from Jim Barry, Chairman, followed by the song "the Bobbies of Carrig" from Michael Cummins. This was followed by Marie McCarthy reciting a beautiful, perfectly written poem, by Kathleen Jeffers entitled "the Christmas Tree". Marie went on to give her thoughts on one of the articles she wrote for the book, which was a snapshot of the Village from the 1950's to the 1970's.

We then had lovely complimentary words from Sarah Kelleher (whose mother Maria, published 3 books), before giving the stage to Denis Walsh. Denis wrote a stunning speech which captured the real essence of this book. Thank you, Denis. You went the extra mile to get the words right on the night.

Much thanks were also due to Caroline Dixey, Mary Carey and all the others who helped on the night to make everybody comfortable. Also to the GAA club who kindly allowed us to use this magnificent facility.

While most of the books were sold on the night, some more were available to be purchased from the "Vincent's" Shop on Main Street Carrigtwohill courtesy of Mary Carey, Nora and all the staff there. The book is now almost completely sold out though there may be a dozen or so left.

A wonderfully successful project.

There are not many copies left, and believed at the time of writing to be about a dozen @ €25 each.



A packed GAA Clubhouse for the Book Launch

Speech by Denis Walsh

It's very strange to be standing up here, in front of so many familiar faces, talking about a place we all know – or think we know. For all of us there is a different version of Carrigtwohill. As we grow older, we are inclined to have a romanticized view of the past and a rose-tinted memory of how things used to be. The best of it is harmless fiction.

A book like this, though, challenges us to think again and open our mind's eye. When we think of history most of us think of school and the things we learned in order to pass an

exam, rammed down our throats like broccoli because it was good for us. Local history, though, is not like that.

The beauty of local history is that it is bound up with human stories and the personal dramas of everyday life. It trains a microscope on the particular and sometimes on the peculiar. It draws back a curtain and allows us to see familiar things in a new and vivid light. Gloriously, this book achieves all of those things.

Before I opened a page, I thought I knew about Carrigtwohill and it turns out I knew next to nothing.

I had no idea how Carrigtwohill got its name, or that the ins and outs of it are contested. The story I love is that Carrig is named after a rock that runs North to South when all of the rock in this part of the country runs East to West. How appropriate that Carrig is named after a rock that is a little bit contrary, refusing to conform – a punk rock if you like. That story must be true. Whatever else has changed in Carrigtwohill, that benign streak of madness must never leave us. It is too precious to our identity, and it is too much fun.

We talk a lot about how Carrig has grown and changed over the last 20 years, and how much more it will grow and change over the next 20 years, but what is abundantly clear from this book is that none of this is new. Through the centuries Carrig has always been shaped by people who arrived here from other places.

From the earliest known settlers more than 4,000 years ago, to the Melesians in 500 BC, to the arrival of the Anglo-Normans and our brush with the Vikings, right up to the arrival of the Sisters of the Poor Servants of the Mother of God 150 years ago, the life of this place, our place, has been moulded by newcomers.

In this century our tribe has expanded in ways that we never could have imagined. The population of Carrigtwohill is among the most diverse of any village in the country, something that is beautifully captured in the later chapters of this book.

That energy is radiant. I know that down here in the GAA club we would be lost without the passion and enthusiasm of people who have come to live in Carrigtwohill over the last 10 or 20 years and have become immersed in the life of our club. The only constant is change. It must be embraced. As a place, Carrigtwohill has always understood that.

In this book there is an extraordinary cast of characters. From cherished pillars of the community such as Tom Barry and Willie O'Brien, to writers and artists and sculptors. There is no question but that the extraordinary life and death of Jemmy Cotter would be the subject of a Netflix docuseries if he had been a contemporary figure. The acclaimed artist William Gerard Barry with his exuberant social life and reported dalliance with the richest woman in America, would be rich fodder for social media if William were with us now.

The chapter on Daithi de Barra, writer and poet, is captivating. Extracts from De Barra's account of the Tithe

Battle on Rossmore Strand bristle with menace and urgency 250 years after the words were written. Every line vibrates on the page.

The stories of these people and many others have been reclaimed from the margins of local memory and by their presence here, introduced to a new audience. Though this a work of local history it also feels like a work of archaeology, the stories painstakingly excavated from unmarked graves and given an afterlife.

The soul of every place is its people, but bricks and mortar have a heart and a history too. This book makes us stop and look again at places we pass every day without a second thought. The chapter about the Main Street, for example, is triumph of time travel. The paint and the plaster on every shop front and home is surgically stripped back to what it used to be.

Every place has layers. When I was growing up, Barryscourt Castle was where the annual Carrigtwohill festival used to reach its climax with a Sunday night concert. It was also an outdoor haven for courting couples, permission neither sought nor granted. We knew nothing of its social and political significance, of how it came to be built and why it was burnt to the ground, or the central role it played in the life of Carrigtwohill for centuries. Everybody has a different version of Carrigtwohill. For a thousand years, the story of the castle has kept changing.

Photographs are a portal into our past. I was thrilled to see a picture of my father Jack in the book, playing the bag pipes as a boy, and my grandfather Dinny, pictured with the point to point committee in the late 1950s. All over the book there are names and faces that will mean something to somebody and spark a memory. The group picture of the staff in Fota in 1945, more than 50 of them, is one treasure among many. It is clear on every page that this book has been a labour of love, from the ingenious use of archive material to the judicious use of oral testimony, to the sourcing of old texts and photographs. As humans, the outer layer of our skin changes about once a month but our fingerprint never changes. The skin of Carrigtwohill as a place has changed a million times through the centuries, but this book has captured its fingerprint.

Everybody who has brought this book to life deserve our praise and gratitude.



Denis Walsh presenting his memorable speech & opening the book launch

Preserving the Augustinian Canon Abbey

Project Update Generally

The year began with the awarding of a grant from the Community Monuments Fund (CMF) permitting us to undertake urgent remedial works to the Augustinian Canon Abbey Tower before it fell into a further ruinous state of repair, or collapse altogether as it threatened to do quite unbeknown to us, and only became evident once the project commenced. The works were performed by Ahern Brothers of Youghal who had previously repointed our Saint Mary's Church. It was managed by Southgate Associates of Midleton and Cork City.

The funding grant amounted to €68K. The GoFundMe page was reinstated to assist with additional expenditure not covered by the CMF award.

As part of our recent progress report circulated last month was included a unique aerial view of the Abbey site with the works then only just commenced. This two-minute video was taken on behalf of the Community Council and the C2H240 steering committee for the historical society. Please take the time to watch it by clicking on the image..



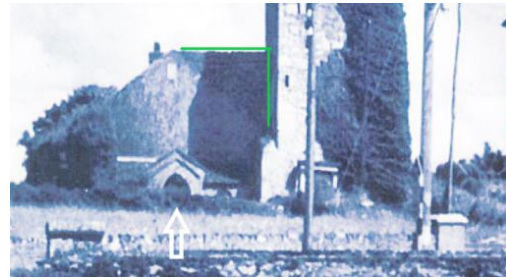
The video was filmed on a DJI mini 3 drone on October 19th, 2025. It simply shows the outside condition and location of the building as it currently stands. After a minute, the drone come directly overhead and give a view of the inside of the tower, open to the elements and invaded by vegetation. The final view shows the precarious condition of the remaining bell, still holding strong, but at risk of dragging the side wall down.

The selected music, a piano transcription of the beginning of Mozart's Requiem in D minor, K. 626 (1791), is a personal choice, guided by the religious significance of the building and its location in the old cemetery.

The project was partially completed as documented in our last circular to the total satisfaction of the County Council's Heritage Department which was signed of in late November with the final payment being made.

The North and East elevations still require some work, as does the cleaning of the interior which was never part of these urgent remedial repairs. In addition, the originally intended ground penetration radar survey needs to be undertaken to determine the extent of the Abbey ruins below ground.

If anyone has photographs or artistic works showing the porch to the former St David's church where the Church Hall extension now stands, we would be grateful to receive them. An image has been seen in a private collection. See arrow below.



Carrigtwohill Through the Centuries

Your kind contribution may be made by clicking this link to our [GoFundMe page](#).

Recent Surveyor's Reports

Previous Site Investigations

An Archaeological Heritage Impact Assessment of the Abbey was undertaken by Southgate Associates in 2025 as part of the Community Monuments Fund proposal. This report concluded that:

- The works proposed to be undertaken at Carrigtwohill Abbey are essential conservation works to repair areas of masonry of the tower and parapets which are in poor condition and at risk of further degradation,
- The works proposed are essential conservation and consolidation works and are necessary to conserve the structure of the building. By following the mitigations suggested above and having regular engagement with the project archaeologist the project is expected to consolidate the proposed areas of this significant medieval monument.

The works then proposed to be undertaken at Abbey were essential conservation works to repair areas of masonry of the tower and parapets which were in poor condition and at risk of further degradation:

- The works proposed were essential conservation and consolidation works necessary to conserve the structure of the building. By following the mitigations suggested above and having regular engagement with the project archaeologist. The expectation is to consolidate the proposed areas of this significant medieval monument.

Sites and Monuments Record No

Licence number: 11E0167

Author: Miriam Carroll, Tobar Archaeological Services
Late Medieval (AD 1100-AD 1599)

Please note highlighted passage.

An assessment for a proposed two-classroom extension to St Mary's Boys National School, Carrigtohill, was undertaken at the request of the County Council. A subsequent condition of planning permission requested a test excavation of the development site. The extension is located near the site of a shell midden (CO075-068) excavated by Michael J. O'Kelly in the 1950s.

Three test trenches were opened on the site in the area of the proposed extension. The trenches were excavated using a 3-tonne mechanical excavator with a 1.5m-wide grading bucket. Testing in the area of the site was limited by the presence of services (water, sewerage etc.) and the depth at which the natural subsoil existed, (c. 1–1.3m below present ground level). The stratigraphy was similar throughout the site, the level of which appears to have been artificially built up. This was evident by the presence of modern fill and possible buried topsoil to a depth of 1.3m. The overburden contained plastic, red brick, crockery and glass. The natural subsoil appears to slope gently from north to south and consists of an orange/yellow silty sand material with few stones. Natural subsoil was exposed at the base of all the trenches. Three archaeological features were uncovered in Trenches 1 and 3. A feature was uncovered in Trench 1 at a depth of 1.25m from present ground level at the eastern end of the trench. The linear feature extended under the northern and southern baulks. It measured 1.3m east west and consisted of a mid-brown silty sand fill with charcoal flecks and few stones. A small section was manually excavated across the feature (1.2m east–west). The cut had a broad, V-shaped profile and measured 0.55m in maximum depth. A sherd of glazed medieval pottery, dating from the 13th 14th century, was recovered from the upper portion of the fill. A second cut feature was also uncovered at the western end of the trench and extended under the northern and western baulks. The fill appeared to be similar to that of the aforementioned linear feature. The exposed portion measured 0.7m north–south by 0.7m. This feature was not manually excavated. A feature was also uncovered at the western end of Trench 3 at a depth of 0.9m below present ground level. The fill was similar to that of the features exposed in Trench 1 and consisted of a mid-brown silty sand material. This linear feature ran north–south and extended under the northern, southern and western baulks. The exposed section measured 0.5m in width (east–west).

The use of a raft foundation during the construction phase of the development meant that any further impacts on archaeology were avoided. The archaeological features occur at a depth of between 0.9m and 1.25m below present ground level. The use of a raft allowed a 0.5m horizontal buffer between the top of the archaeology and the base of the raft. Monitoring of services was also undertaken under the same licence in 2011, during which time no archaeological finds or features were uncovered (Lir Archaeology (Heritage & Planning Consultancy))

The Archaeologist visited the site prior to works commencement to assess specific areas where proposed works were to be undertaken to check for the presence of archaeological material.

- The project archaeologist was kept informed of all works and was requested in person to monitor as required if original mortar was removed.
- The Architect was to be informed of any artefacts, new archaeological fabric or otherwise notable archaeological element discovered during works. If any were found the works were to be halted pending an inspection by the project archaeologist and notification to the National Monuments Service where necessary.
- A photographic record was maintained during works as this would assist to inform and record our understanding of building techniques of the period and all to increase knowledge of how to effectively conserve buildings of this type and date.
- Where vegetation removal was required, it was to be carried out in line with the accompanying conservation methodology, as no stone must be dislodged, or removed. In the case of turf and soil, it must be assessed for small finds of an archaeological nature.
- The project archaeologist visited the site prior to work's commencement to assess specific areas where works were proposed to check for the presence of archaeological material, and that only areas where specified by conservation engineer must be repaired. The original finished faces of the parapets and crenellations must be retained as will the straight sections of parapet between each corner. Artificial right angles etc must not be created. Restoration to original is not desired, consolidation safely only.
- The project archaeologist must be kept informed of all works and be requested in person for monitoring as required when/if original mortar was being removed. Should any artefacts, new archaeological fabric or otherwise notable archaeological element be discovered during works the works should be halted pending an inspection by the project archaeologist and notification to the National Monuments Service where necessary.
- A photographic record was maintained during works to inform and record our understanding of building techniques of the period and all to increase knowledge of how to effectively conserve buildings of this type and date.
- Where vegetation removal was required, it was carried out in line with the accompanying conservation methodology, no stonework was dislodged or removed; nor turf & soil removed to be assessed for small finds of an archaeological nature.
- Fully photographically record of bell and frame prior was maintained during and after works; and to ensure minimal layers of anti-corrosion product and paint as per manufacturers guidance. and conservation engineer direction.

Poor Servants of the Mother of God – 150 years in Carrigtwohill.

By John Fitzgerald

The following is a synopsis of the full story which appeared our book of the parish history with a few editorials.

In 1875, Carrigtwohill was a small village on the main road between Cork City and Midleton with a population of about 700 people. Today Carrigtwohill is a satellite town just 10 minutes' drive from Cork City with a population of nearly 6,000. In today's world of social media, we hear much talk about 'influencers', for us the SMG Sisters were the original influencers and with our 150th anniversary celebrations, our community welcomed the opportunity to explore and celebrate that positive influence.

It quickly emerged that the main activities on the anniversary weekend of 21st and 22nd of June, would be a re-enactment of the arrival of Mother Taylor, and her two companion Sisters, at the old Carrigtwohill Railway Station in 1875 and an exhibition that would run over the two days in the Community Centre, exploring the lives and work of the SMG Sisters and their influence on our community.

The was the highlight of our weekend was the re-enactment of the Sisters' arrival. It was obvious that the meticulous planning and long hours of preparation involved, had paid off. The Sisters habits, the costumes of the 'locals', the 'Cead Mile Fáilte' banner, the piper leading the walk to the church, all contributed to the sense of nostalgia and celebration. Those attending were privileged to get some insight into what a momentous occasion it must have been for this small country village 150 years ago.



Cead Mile Fáilte as it was 150 years ago & still is today

Following a number of preparation meetings, it became clear that our exhibition should featuring the Sisters history, work and influence in Carrigtwohill.

It was felt important to begin by setting the historical scene of the Ireland and Carrigtwohill to which the Sisters arrived in 1875. it was just twenty-five years after the Irish Famine, a time of tenant farmers and evictions, of rising Nationalism and the nearby Midleton Workhouse was the last resort for many.



A partial view of our exhibition – prior to the opening

Since its foundation the SMG Congregation had limited funds, few recruits and could only afford to rent condemned houses in London. Brentford was the first house bought in England and that happened in 1882, ten years after the foundation. Therefore, in 1875, Carrigtwohill would be the Congregation's first house, a foundational mission for the Sisters.

As it turned out, what the community of Carrigtwohill lacked in size they made up for with enthusiasm and support, beginning with the reception the Sisters received on their arrival in Carrigtwohill:

“Finally, on that glorious summer's day, the Feast of St Aloysius, 21st June 1875, Mother Magdalen of the Poor Servants of the Mother of God, with Sisters Mary Agnes Manderson and Mary Francis Murphy, arrived at Railway Station. They were astonished to be met by the entire village, including the children dressed in festive attire, being led by their Parish Priest, Richard Seymour. They proceeded to their new parish church, as flowers were strewn beneath their feet, under a triumphal banner of 'Céad Mile Fáilte' held aloft by the men of this community. Here they recited the Rosary and held a hymn service.”

We wanted to feature some Sisters who live in the memory of their colleagues, school pupils and the people of Carrigtwohill. We displayed many relevant photographs of individual and groups of Sisters over the years and we also created profiles of some of the Sisters who had a long history and influence in Carrigtwohill.

Very early in our preparations, the Sisters were anxious to feature the eleven native women of Carrigtwohill who entered the SMG Congregation since its foundation. We were delighted with the enthusiasm of their families who helped us to populate their family trees and provided family photographs. It was fascinating to explore the broad family connections with many of today's Carrigtwohill families, which added to the sense that the SMG Congregation is embedded in the Carrigtwohill DNA.



A mock-up of Convent's Door of Hope

The quote over the door, from Mother Taylor, "For them we toil, for them we labour, that we may be worthy to be in their service", gives a unique insight into Mother Taylor's thinking and the motivation behind her work.

It seemed fitting that Pope Francis opening the 'Holy Door' in Rome and declaring 2025 a Jubilee Year of Hope, coincided with the 150th anniversary of the arrival of the 'Poor Servants of the Mother of God' who have provided a 'Door of Hope' for so many over the past 150 years. So many had their hopes and needs encouraged and fulfilled.

Community groups like the Community Council, who facilitated our exhibition in the Community Centre, were totally supportive. The Tidy Towns group who spent two days cleaning around the Old Railway Station and the Station Road, also donated and installed a 'Park Bench' as a permanent tribute to the 150 years of the Carrigtwohill SMG Sisters. The GAA framed the jersey, knitted by the convent 'Knit and Natter' group, which is a replica of the jerseys knitted by the Sisters in 1918 for the Carrigtwohill Senior Hurling team who won the Cork County Championship, the jersey will be permanently displayed in the GAA clubhouse.

We also featured the international work of the SMG Sisters, with a map showing the SMG Foundations in many countries around the World. We featured, especially the work in Kenya and Venezuela. Our raffle at the exhibition, raised €1920 for the work in Kenya.

When the SMG Sisters arrived in Carrigtwohill, they immediately began to work with the poor. The poor of the village were discreetly provided for through a private door. This was a time when there was no social welfare or social supports. Locals testified that their families would not have survived without the support of the Sisters.



Alan O'Connor with his painting of Carrigtwohill depicting his impression of the arrival of the SMG Sisters.

Our thanks to Paul Shaw, SMG Congregational Archivist in London, who has been of great assistance, and we are especially grateful to André Saubolle of the Carrigtwohill and District Historical Society for unselfishly sharing his historical work and research. Our thanks are also extended to the so many who assisted us in making the weekend the success that it was.

Thanks be to God.

There is much more to be learnt by John's article published in the Parish History Book. In addition, an article by Sr Mary Kenifick (SMG) may be read in this year's Holly Bough.



Some of the present Carrigtwohill SMG Sisters

*May we conclude by wishing all our members, their families and friends
a Merry & Peaceful Christmas
&
a Happy New Year*

Chair: Jim Barry
Treasurer: Michael Cummins

Vice Chair:
Members: Sister Mary Kenefick (SMG), Marie FitzGerald McCarthy, Frank Hannigan, Ollie Sheehan, and William Ahern

Secretary: André Saubolle **Vice Secretary:** Tony Ó Floinn